=, >, <, >=, ⇐, BETWEEN x AND y, and begins_with. Sort key operators are blazing fast because the data is already sorted.

② Dynamic values are referenced in the expression.

③ Always specify the correct type (S, N, B).

④ Invokes the query operation on DynamoDB

The `query` operation also lets you specify an optional `FilterExpression`, to include only items that match the filter and key condition. This is helpful to reduce the result set, for example, to show only tasks of a specific category. The syntax of `FilterExpression` works like `KeyConditionExpression`, but no index is used for filters. Filters are applied to all matches that `KeyConditionExpression` returns.

To list all tasks for a certain user, you must query DynamoDB. The primary key of a task is the combination of the `uid` and the `tid`. To get all tasks for a user, `KeyConditionExpression` requires only the partition key.

The next listing shows two helper functions used to implement the `task-ls` command.

Listing 12.10 nodetodo: Retrieving tasks (index.js)

```
const getValue = (attribute, type) => {    ①
  if (attribute === undefined) {
    return null;
  }
  return attribute[type];
};

const mapTaskItem = (item) => {            ②
  return {
    tid: item.tid.N,
    description: item.description.S,
    created: item.created.N,
    due: getValue(item.due, 'N'),
    category: getValue(item.category, 'S'),
```